



UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE INTERNATIONAL EXAMINATIONS
International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/31

Paper 3 Directed Writing and Composition

May/June 2013

READING BOOKLET INSERT

2 hours

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Section 1, Question 1** on the Question Paper.

You may annotate this Insert and use the blank spaces for planning. This Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

This document consists of **2** printed pages and **2** blank pages.



Read the following article carefully, and then answer Question 1 on the Question Paper.

In this article, Ravenna Reach expresses her views about the prominence given to the modern Olympic Games.

Olympic Overkill

Well, now it's over and we can count the cost. Everyone will say that it was worth it. However, there is great suffering in the world, and there's never enough money to provide healthcare, education, food and water for those who need it so much. Instead we spend billions building the Olympic stadium, providing accommodation for athletes and famous visitors, making huge processions and letting off countless fireworks. These pollute the atmosphere which we spend good money trying to keep clean. £30 million went on simply preparing the British team for 2012, and that amount ran out a year before the opening ceremony, when money for looking after the elderly and providing facilities for young people had been cut owing to the general economic situation.

There are two odd things about the Olympics. One is that despite the superficial packaging and decoration, it all comes down to people running round tracks and swimming in pools much as they have done for countless years. There is nothing that necessarily demands vast expense, although no doubt the athletes wear flashy fashion sportswear. The whole thing could be organised for a fraction of the cost and yet provide 100 per cent competition and entertainment. It just needs plenty of room!

The other odd thing is that each time the Olympic Games takes place you would think that it was the last because of the huge build-up and nations attempting to outdo each other. Yet the Olympic Games happens every four years, so that as soon as the media hype about one competition ends, the same old stories are repeated for the next. Will the stadium be finished in time? Will the athletes who took part in this competition be better or worse in four years' time? Will the security arrangements be sufficient? It never ends!

I'm not against the Olympics: far from it. It's a marvellous part of living history that something which started 2,700 years ago at Olympia in Greece, in honour of the god Zeus, should still continue. Did you know that a month before the original Games, a truce between warring factions was declared in the region so that people could travel and enjoy them in peace? Hence the Games were always associated with peace and friendship. At the first one-day Olympic Games, the only event was a sprint from one end of the stadium to the other. Gradually more events were added to make four days of competitions. Amazingly, athletes from all over the world still compete in these events. I think it's marvellous that in recent years there has been such a constant growth in the number of athletes taking part and the variety of sports, which now include taekwondo and synchronised swimming. What a spectacle! It is awe-inspiring to see so many athletes taking part and so many countries in harmony, at least in theory, over the period of the Games.

Lastly, one of the very best things about the Olympics is the inclusion of the Paralympic Games, held immediately after the main games and given the same status and ceremonies. This event allows disabled athletes to compete at the highest level in sports that include cycling, football five-a-side and wheelchair tennis. Apart from the athletes' magnificent achievements, this is excellent spectator sport.

So if you measure up the arguments about the Olympics, you see that they are pretty evenly matched. The Games can be one of the strongest messages for world peace in our often quarrelsome international community. For a host country, the newly built stadiums and other facilities can encourage more people to enjoy sport. After all the preparations, the excitement and the competition live on!



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CANDIDATE
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NUMBER

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Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name in the spaces provided.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do **not** use staples, paper clips, glue or correction fluid.

DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Answer **two** questions: **Question 1** in **Section 1** and **one** question from **Section 2**. Answer in the space provided. If additional space is required, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet. The question number(s) must be clearly shown.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Question 1, Section 1** on this Question Paper. The Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **10** printed pages, **2** blank pages and **1** Reading Booklet Insert.

1 Read carefully the article by Ravenna Reach about the Olympic Games in the Reading Booklet Insert. Then answer Section 1, Question 1 on this Question Paper.

You may agree or disagree with the writer's arguments.

- identify and evaluate the writer's views
- use your own ideas to support your comments on the writer's views.

Begin your letter: 'Dear Ravenna Reach...'.

Write between 1½ and 2 sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dotted lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a guide for handwriting practice. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

[illegible]

This image shows a full page of primary-ruled paper. It features multiple sets of horizontal dashed lines spaced evenly down the page, providing a guide for handwriting practice. The paper is otherwise blank, with no margins or additional markings.

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Section 2: Composition

Write about two sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting, on **one** of the following questions.

Up to 13 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 12 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

Argumentative/Discursive Writing

- 2 (a) 'There's no such thing in this world as an easy job.' Give your views.

OR

- (b) Explain some of the admirable **and** less admirable qualities of your age group.

Descriptive Writing

- 3 (a) Describe a noisy group of people passing by, and your thoughts and feelings about them at the time.

OR

- (b) Describe a place that is very old and has a powerful atmosphere.

Narrative Writing

- 4 (a) Write a story based on an unusual and exciting secret.

OR

- (b) 'One moment she was there, and the next...'. Use this sentence to start your story.

[Turn to page 6 to answer Section 2]

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dotted lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a guide for handwriting practice. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

If you use the following lined pages to complete the answer(s) to any question(s), the question number(s) must be clearly shown.

This image shows a single page of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

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If you use the following lined pages to complete the answer(s) to any question(s), the question number(s) must be clearly shown.

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of multiple sets of three horizontal dotted lines, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The lines are evenly spaced across the entire page, leaving ample room for writing practice. There is no text or other markings on the page.